

Prep Patter

El Paso Prepsters Close Long Season

By BERT SALAZAR

It was a long season for sports in El Paso during 1967-68.

Students will wave goodbye to teachers and coaches this week. School ends Friday.

TO SOME, their sport eligibility ends this week ... to others it may mean the beginning of a better career in sports.

Some athletes, although great in high school competition, will not be able to survive the stiff competition that awaits in college.

Many El Paso athletes will stay here to attend the University of Texas at El Paso with scholarships.

Bill Craig, of Burges, is one of them and Charley Beall of Coronado is another.

Craig is considered the best quarterback in the district with Beall being tapped as one of the toughest ends.

COACH Wayne Vandenburg (UTEP track mentor) recruited the best miler that has ever come out of El Paso in Carlos Sarinana of Tech. Last great miler locally was Javier Montes, who attended UTEP.

UTEP's first wrestling coach, Bruno Rolack, is considering grabbing some of the local talent for UTEP's first mat team. Enrique Alvarez of Jefferson is on the list.

No basketball player from El Paso has been named to the Don Haskins team for the coming season.

Nate Stephens of Jefferson the tallest player around, has received many scholarships and may not attend UTEP.

Feeling among some people is that Stephens will not survive the turmoil, pressure, sweat and determination that is becoming of a good basketball player. Here's hoping he proves them wrong.

IT IS too early for UTEP to recruit local baseball players. Andy Cohen of the Miners will have to take a look at Ysleta's pitcher Raul Marquez. Marquez not only has good control in his delivery but is also a good hitter.

Another prospect to consider for a baseball job with the Miners would be shortstop Sylvan Rothschild of Coronado.

LITTLE LEAGUE, Babe Ruth, Connie Mack and other boys baseball will be in the spotlight during the summer months.

Speaking of boys, there is a youngster at Ross intermediate school who told his coach, Wally Hartley, that he would break the 440 yard record of 54.9 before the season ended.

His name is Manny Avila, whose first 440 yard was run in 56.9.

In the intermediate City finals at Irvin May 4, Manny ran the 440 event in a record breaking time of 54.1, eight tenths of a second off the old record. Congratulations Manny.